



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF PHILOSOPHY AND RELIGIOUS STUDIES

CAT 1

FIRST SEMESTER, 2025/2026

UCU 111: CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

CAT 1: DR. NZIOKA'S CLASS

Instructions:

- i. *Answer The Following Questions*
- ii. *AI generated answers will be awarded 0/40*
- iii. *Plagiarized Work will be awarded 0/40*
- iv. *The assignment should be done in groups of not more than 10 people.*

USE THE SCENARIO BELOW TO ANSWER ALL THE QUESTIONS

In 2025, Kenya has seen intense discussions about gender equality, economic pressures, political accountability, and the evolving roles of men and women in society. Social media conversations, youth forums, and campus debates frequently focus on unemployment, the cost of living, and shifting expectations around leadership and domestic responsibilities.

Mercy, a fourth-year Kenyatta university student, strongly believes that society functions best when people conform to traditional norms but not always—particularly regarding gender roles. She argues that:

- Men must always be the main providers, regardless of economic challenges or unemployment trends.
- Women should be provided for, cared for, and protected by men. After all, the Bible clearly stipulates this role for men.

- Women are not subject to traditional gender roles because they are oppressive to women. They can be independent and men must learn to cope with the new and improved woman.
- Men should show love by sometimes performing roles assigned to women such as cooking, cleaning and taking care of children.
- Women should be empowered and given opportunities through affirmative action. However, their responsibility is not to men but to themselves. A man can and should care for himself.
- Cultural events like dowry payment should continue because it shows appreciation to the woman's family.

In class discussions on fairness and equality, she publicly defends cultural expectations placed on men to “step up,” while discouraging debates that critically examine whether these norms are equitable or realistic in Kenya's current economic climate.

QUESTIONS

(Total: 40 Marks)

1. Using the case study, identify and explain Four (3) characteristics of a thinker operating at the Conventional Level of moral and critical reasoning. Use examples from Mercy's behaviour to support your points. (20 marks)
2. Propose Four (3) practical (borrow from tools of analysis or evaluation or both) ways that a Kenyatta University student like Mercy can apply to transition from Conventional Thinking to Post-Conventional Thinking. The strategies should demonstrate critical and problem-solving thinking skills. (20 marks)